

A decorative border with intricate floral and scrollwork patterns in a dark green color, framing the central text.

BibInVs MN 22

Song Of Solomon

Bible Translation:
Interverse MSG/NIV - 22

God

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Interversed Message/NIV Bible

Song of Solomon

Song of Solomon 1

MSG

NIV

- 1 The Song--best of all songs--Solomon's song!
- 1 Solomon's Song of Songs.
- 2 Kiss me--full on the mouth! Yes! For your love is better than wine,
- 2 Let him kiss me with the kisses of his mouth-- for your love is more delightful than wine.
- 3 headier than your aromatic oils. The syllables of your name murmur like a meadow brook. No wonder everyone loves to say your name!
- 3 Pleasing is the fragrance of your perfumes; your name is like perfume poured out. No wonder the maidens love you!
- 4 Take me away with you! Let's run off together! An elopement with my King-Lover! We'll celebrate, we'll sing, we'll make great music. Yes! For your love is better than vintage wine. Everyone loves you--of course! And why not?
- 4 Take me away with you--let us hurry! Let the king bring me into his chambers. We rejoice and delight in you; we will praise your love more than wine. How right they are to adore you!
- 5 I am weathered but still elegant, oh, dear sisters in Jerusalem, Weather-darkened like Kedar desert tents, time-softened like Solomon's Temple hangings.
- 5 Dark am I, yet lovely, O daughters of Jerusalem, dark like the tents of Kedar, like the tent curtains of Solomon.
- 6 Don't look down on me because I'm dark, darkened by the sun's harsh rays. My brothers ridiculed me and sent me to work in the fields. They made me care for the face of the earth, but I had no time to care for my own face.
- 6 Do not stare at me because I am dark, because I am darkened by the sun. My mother's sons were angry with me and made me take care of the

vineyards; my own vineyard I have neglected.

- 7 Tell me where you're working --I love you so much--Tell me where you're tending your flocks, where you let them rest at noontime. Why should I be the one left out, outside the orbit of your tender care?
- 7 Tell me, you whom I love, where you graze your flock and where you rest your sheep at midday. Why should I be like a veiled woman beside the flocks of your friends?
- 8 If you can't find me, loveliest of all women, it's all right. Stay with your flocks. Lead your lambs to good pasture. Stay with your shepherd neighbors.
- 8 If you do not know, most beautiful of women, follow the tracks of the sheep and graze your young goats by the tents of the shepherds.
- 9 You remind me of Pharaoh's well-groomed and satiny mares.
- 9 I liken you, my darling, to a mare harnessed to one of the chariots of Pharaoh.
- 10 Pendant earrings line the elegance of your cheeks; strands of jewels illumine the curve of your throat.
- 10 Your cheeks are beautiful with earrings, your neck with strings of jewels.
- 11 I'm making jewelry for you, gold and silver jewelry that will mark and accent your beauty.
- 11 We will make you earrings of gold, studded with silver.
- 12 When my King-Lover lay down beside me, my fragrance filled the room.
- 12 While the king was at his table, my perfume spread its fragrance.
- 13 His head resting between my breasts--the head of my lover was a sachet of sweet myrrh.
- 13 My lover is to me a sachet of myrrh resting between my breasts.
- 14 My beloved is a bouquet of wildflowers picked just for me from the fields of Engedi.
- 14 My lover is to me a cluster of henna blossoms from the vineyards of En Gedi.
- 15 Oh, my dear friend! You're so beautiful! And your eyes so beautiful--like doves!
- 15 How beautiful you are, my darling! Oh, how beautiful! Your eyes are doves.

- 16 And you, my dear lover--you're so handsome! And the bed we share is like a forest glen.
- 16 How handsome you are, my lover! Oh, how charming! And our bed is verdant.
- 17 We enjoy a canopy of cedars enclosed by cypresses, fragrant and green.
- 17 The beams of our house are cedars; our rafters are firs.

Song of Solomon 2

MSG

NIV

- 1 I'm just a wildflower picked from the plains of Sharon, a lotus blossom from the valley pools.
- 1 I am a rose of Sharon, a lily of the valleys.
- 2 A lotus blossoming in a swamp of weeds-- that's my dear friend among the girls in the village.
- 2 Like a lily among thorns is my darling among the maidens.
- 3 As an apricot tree stands out in the forest, my lover stands above the young men in town. All I want is to sit in his shade, to taste and savor his delicious love.
- 3 Like an apple tree among the trees of the forest is my lover among the young men. I delight to sit in his shade, and his fruit is sweet to my taste.
- 4 He took me home with him for a festive meal, but his eyes feasted on me!
- 4 He has taken me to the banquet hall, and his banner over me is love.
- 5 Oh! Give me something refreshing to eat--and quickly! Apricots, raisins--anything. I'm about to faint with love!
- 5 Strengthen me with raisins, refresh me with apples, for I am faint with love.
- 6 His left hand cradles my head, and his right arm encircles my waist!
- 6 His left arm is under my head, and his right arm embraces me.
- 7 Oh, let me warn you, sisters in Jerusalem, by the gazelles, yes, by all the wild deer: Don't excite love, don't stir it up, until the time is ripe--and you're ready.
- 7 Daughters of Jerusalem, I charge you by the gazelles and by the does of the field: Do not arouse or awaken love until it so desires.

- 8 Look! Listen! There's my lover! Do you see him coming? Vaulting the mountains, leaping the hills.
- 8 Listen! My lover! Look! Here he comes, leaping across the mountains, bounding over the hills.
- 9 My lover is like a gazelle, graceful; like a young stag, virile. Look at him there, on tiptoe at the gate, all ears, all eyes--ready!
- 9 My lover is like a gazelle or a young stag. Look! There he stands behind our wall, gazing through the windows, peering through the lattice.
- 10 My lover has arrived and he's speaking to me! Get up, my dear friend, fair and beautiful lover--come to me!
- 10 My lover spoke and said to me, "Arise, my darling, my beautiful one, and come with me.
- 11 Look around you: Winter is over; the winter rains are over, gone!
- 11 See! The winter is past; the rains are over and gone.
- 12 Spring flowers are in blossom all over. The whole world's a choir--and singing! Spring warblers are filling the forest with sweet arpeggios.
- 12 Flowers appear on the earth; the season of singing has come, the cooing of doves is heard in our land.
- 13 Lilacs are exuberantly purple and perfumed, and cherry trees fragrant with blossoms. Oh, get up, dear friend, my fair and beautiful lover--come to me!
- 13 The fig tree forms its early fruit; the blossoming vines spread their fragrance. Arise, come, my darling; my beautiful one, come with me."
- 14 Come, my shy and modest dove-- leave your seclusion, come out in the open. Let me see your face, let me hear your voice. For your voice is soothing and your face is ravishing.
- 14 My dove in the clefts of the rock, in the hiding places on the mountainside, show me your face, let me hear your voice; for your voice is sweet, and your face is lovely.
- 15 Then you must protect me from the foxes, foxes on the prowl, Foxes who would like nothing better than to get into our flowering garden.
- 15 Catch for us the foxes, the little foxes that ruin the vineyards, our vineyards that are in bloom.
- 16 My lover is mine, and I am his. Nightly he strolls in our garden, Delighting in the flowers
- 16 My lover is mine and I am his; he browses among the lilies.

17 until dawn breathes its light and night slips away. Turn to me, dear lover. Come like a gazelle. Leap like a wild stag on delectable mountains!

17 Until the day breaks and the shadows flee, turn, my lover, and be like a gazelle or like a young stag on the rugged hills.

Song of Solomon 3

MSG

NIV

1 Restless in bed and sleepless through the night, I longed for my lover. I wanted him desperately. His absence was painful.

1 All night long on my bed I looked for the one my heart loves; I looked for him but did not find him.

2 So I got up, went out and roved the city, hunting through streets and down alleys. I wanted my lover in the worst way! I looked high and low, and didn't find him.

2 I will get up now and go about the city, through its streets and squares; I will search for the one my heart loves. So I looked for him but did not find him.

3 And then the night watchmen found me as they patrolled the darkened city. "Have you seen my dear lost love?" I asked.

3 The watchmen found me as they made their rounds in the city. "Have you seen the one my heart loves?"

4 No sooner had I left them than I found him, found my dear lost love. I threw my arms around him and held him tight, wouldn't let him go until I had him home again, safe at home beside the fire.

4 Scarcely had I passed them when I found the one my heart loves. I held him and would not let him go till I had brought him to my mother's house, to the room of the one who conceived me.

5 Oh, let me warn you, sisters in Jerusalem, by the gazelles, yes, by all the wild deer: Don't excite love, don't stir it up, until the time is ripe--and you're ready.

5 Daughters of Jerusalem, I charge you by the gazelles and by the does of the field: Do not arouse or awaken love until it so desires.

- 6 What's this I see, approaching from the desert, raising clouds of dust,
Filling the air with sweet smells and pungent aromatics?
- 6 Who is this coming up from the desert like a column of smoke, perfumed
with myrrh and incense made from all the spices of the merchant?
- 7 Look! It's Solomon's carriage, carried and guarded by sixty soldiers, sixty
of Israel's finest,
- 7 Look! It is Solomon's carriage, escorted by sixty warriors, the noblest of
Israel,
- 8 All of them armed to the teeth, trained for battle, ready for anything,
anytime.
- 8 all of them wearing the sword, all experienced in battle, each with his
sword at his side, prepared for the terrors of the night.
- 9 King Solomon once had a carriage built from fine-grained Lebanon
cedar.
- 9 King Solomon made for himself the carriage; he made it of wood from
Lebanon.
- 10 He had it framed with silver and roofed with gold. The cushions were
covered with a purple fabric, the interior lined with tooled leather.
- 10 Its posts he made of silver, its base of gold. Its seat was upholstered
with purple, its interior lovingly inlaid by the daughters of Jerusalem.
- 11 Come and look, sisters in Jerusalem. Oh, sisters of Zion, don't miss this!
My King-Lover, dressed and garlanded for his wedding, his heart full,
bursting with joy!
- 11 Come out, you daughters of Zion, and look at King Solomon wearing
the crown, the crown with which his mother crowned him on the day of
his wedding, the day his heart rejoiced.

Song of Solomon 4

MSG

NIV

- 1 You're so beautiful, my darling, so beautiful, and your dove eyes are
veiled By your hair as it flows and shimmers, like a flock of goats in the
distance streaming down a hillside in the sunshine.
- 1 How beautiful you are, my darling! Oh, how beautiful! Your eyes behind
your veil are doves. Your hair is like a flock of goats descending from

Mount Gilead.

- 2 Your smile is generous and full-- expressive and strong and clean.
- 2 Your teeth are like a flock of sheep just shorn, coming up from the washing. Each has its twin; not one of them is alone.
- 3 Your lips are jewel red, your mouth elegant and inviting, your veiled cheeks soft and radiant.
- 3 Your lips are like a scarlet ribbon; your mouth is lovely. Your temples behind your veil are like the halves of a pomegranate.
- 4 The smooth, lithe lines of your neck command notice--all heads turn in awe and admiration!
- 4 Your neck is like the tower of David, built with elegance; on it hang a thousand shields, all of them shields of warriors.
- 5 Your breasts are like fawns, twins of a gazelle, grazing among the first spring flowers.
- 5 Your two breasts are like two fawns, like twin fawns of a gazelle that browse among the lilies.
- 6 The sweet, fragrant curves of your body, the soft, spiced contours of your flesh Invite me, and I come. I stay until dawn breathes its light and night slips away.
- 6 Until the day breaks and the shadows flee, I will go to the mountain of myrrh and to the hill of incense.
- 7 You're beautiful from head to toe, my dear love, beautiful beyond compare, absolutely flawless.
- 7 All beautiful you are, my darling; there is no flaw in you.
- 8 Come with me from Lebanon, my bride. Leave Lebanon behind, and come. Leave your high mountain hideaway. Abandon your wilderness seclusion, Where you keep company with lions and panthers guard your safety.
- 8 Come with me from Lebanon, my bride, come with me from Lebanon. Descend from the crest of Amana, from the top of Senir, the summit of Hermon, from the lions' dens and the mountain haunts of the leopards.
- 9 You've captured my heart, dear friend. You looked at me, and I fell in love. One look my way and I was hopelessly in love!
- 9 You have stolen my heart, my sister, my bride; you have stolen my heart with one glance of your eyes, with one jewel of your necklace.

- 10 How beautiful your love, dear, dear friend-- far more pleasing than a fine, rare wine, your fragrance more exotic than select spices.
- 10 How delightful is your love, my sister, my bride! How much more pleasing is your love than wine, and the fragrance of your perfume than any spice!
- 11 The kisses of your lips are honey, my love, every syllable you speak a delicacy to savor. Your clothes smell like the wild outdoors, the ozone scent of high mountains.
- 11 Your lips drop sweetness as the honeycomb, my bride; milk and honey are under your tongue. The fragrance of your garments is like that of Lebanon.
- 12 Dear lover and friend, you're a secret garden, a private and pure fountain.
- 12 You are a garden locked up, my sister, my bride; you are a spring enclosed, a sealed fountain.
- 13 Body and soul, you are paradise, a whole orchard of succulent fruits-- Ripe apricots and peaches, oranges and pears; Nut trees and cinnamon, and all scented woods;
- 13 Your plants are an orchard of pomegranates with choice fruits, with henna and nard,
- 14 Mint and lavender, and all herbs aromatic;
- 14 nard and saffron, calamus and cinnamon, with every kind of incense tree, with myrrh and aloes and all the finest spices.
- 15 A garden fountain, sparkling and splashing, fed by spring waters from the Lebanon mountains.
- 15 You are a garden fountain, a well of flowing water streaming down from Lebanon.
- 16 Wake up, North Wind, get moving, South Wind! Breathe on my garden, fill the air with spice fragrance. Oh, let my lover enter his garden! Yes, let him eat the fine, ripe fruits.
- 16 Awake, north wind, and come, south wind! Blow on my garden, that its fragrance may spread abroad. Let my lover come into his garden and taste its choice fruits.

Song of Solomon 5

MSG

NIV

- 1 I went to my garden, dear friend, best lover! breathed the sweet fragrance. I ate the fruit and honey, I drank the nectar and wine. Celebrate with me, friends! Raise your glasses--"To life! To love!"
- 1 I have come into my garden, my sister, my bride; I have gathered my myrrh with my spice. I have eaten my honeycomb and my honey; I have drunk my wine and my milk. Eat, O friends, and drink; drink your fill, O lovers.
- 2 I was sound asleep, but in my dreams I was wide awake. Oh, listen! It's the sound of my lover knocking, calling! "Let me in, dear companion, dearest friend, my dove, consummate lover! I'm soaked with the dampness of the night, drenched with dew, shivering and cold."
- 2 I slept but my heart was awake. Listen! My lover is knocking: "Open to me, my sister, my darling, my dove, my flawless one. My head is drenched with dew, my hair with the dampness of the night."
- 3 "But I'm in my nightgown--do you expect me to get dressed? I'm bathed and in bed--do you want me to get dirty?"
- 3 I have taken off my robe-- must I put it on again? I have washed my feet-- must I soil them again?
- 4 But my lover wouldn't take no for an answer, and the longer he knocked, the more excited I became.
- 4 My lover thrust his hand through the latch-opening; my heart began to pound for him.
- 5 I got up to open the door to my lover, sweetly ready to receive him, Desiring and expectant as I turned the door handle.
- 5 I arose to open for my lover, and my hands dripped with myrrh, my fingers with flowing myrrh, on the handles of the lock.
- 6 But when I opened the door he was gone. My loved one had tired of waiting and left. And I died inside--oh, I felt so bad! I ran out looking for him But he was nowhere to be found. I called into the darkness--but no answer.
- 6 I opened for my lover, but my lover had left; he was gone. My heart sank at his departure. I looked for him but did not find him. I called him but he did not answer.

- 7 The night watchmen found me as they patrolled the streets of the city. They slapped and beat and bruised me, ripping off my clothes, These watchmen, who were supposed to be guarding the city.
- 7 The watchmen found me as they made their rounds in the city. They beat me, they bruised me; they took away my cloak, those watchmen of the walls!
- 8 I beg you, sisters in Jerusalem-- if you find my lover, Please tell him I want him, that I'm heartsick with love for him.
- 8 O daughters of Jerusalem, I charge you-- if you find my lover, what will you tell him? Tell him I am faint with love.
- 9 What's so great about your lover, fair lady? What's so special about him that you beg for our help?
- 9 How is your beloved better than others, most beautiful of women? How is your beloved better than others, that you charge us so?
- 10 My dear lover glows with health-- red-blooded, radiant! He's one in a million. There's no one quite like him!
- 10 My lover is radiant and ruddy, outstanding among ten thousand.
- 11 My golden one, pure and untarnished, with raven black curls tumbling across his shoulders.
- 11 His head is purest gold; his hair is wavy and black as a raven.
- 12 His eyes are like doves, soft and bright, but deep-set, brimming with meaning, like wells of water.
- 12 His eyes are like doves by the water streams, washed in milk, mounted like jewels.
- 13 His face is rugged, his beard smells like sage, His voice, his words, warm and reassuring.
- 13 His cheeks are like beds of spice yielding perfume. His lips are like lilies dripping with myrrh.
- 14 Fine muscles ripple beneath his skin, quiet and beautiful. His torso is the work of a sculptor, hard and smooth as ivory.
- 14 His arms are rods of gold set with chrysolite. His body is like polished ivory decorated with sapphires.
- 15 He stands tall, like a cedar, strong and deep-rooted, A rugged mountain of a man, aromatic with wood and stone.
- 15 His legs are pillars of marble set on bases of pure gold. His appearance is like Lebanon, choice as its cedars.

16 His words are kisses, his kisses words. Everything about him delights me, thrills me through and through! That's my lover, that's my man, dear Jerusalem sisters.

16 His mouth is sweetness itself; he is altogether lovely. This is my lover, this my friend, O daughters of Jerusalem.

Song of Solomon 6

MSG

NIV

1 So where has this love of yours gone, fair one? Where on earth can he be? Can we help you look for him?

1 Where has your lover gone, most beautiful of women? Which way did your lover turn, that we may look for him with you?

2 Never mind. My lover is already on his way to his garden, to browse among the flowers, touching the colors and forms.

2 My lover has gone down to his garden, to the beds of spices, to browse in the gardens and to gather lilies.

3 I am my lover's and my lover is mine. He caresses the sweet-smelling flowers.

3 I am my lover's and my lover is mine; he browses among the lilies.

4 Dear, dear friend and lover, you're as beautiful as Tirzah, city of delights, Lovely as Jerusalem, city of dreams, the ravishing visions of my ecstasy.

4 You are beautiful, my darling, as Tirzah, lovely as Jerusalem, majestic as troops with banners.

5 Your beauty is too much for me--I'm in over my head. I'm not used to this! I can't take it in. Your hair flows and shimmers like a flock of goats in the distance streaming down a hillside in the sunshine.

5 Turn your eyes from me; they overwhelm me. Your hair is like a flock of goats descending from Gilead.

6 Your smile is generous and full-- expressive and strong and clean.

6 Your teeth are like a flock of sheep coming up from the washing. Each has its twin, not one of them is alone.

7 Your veiled cheeks are soft and radiant.

7 Your temples behind your veil are like the halves of a pomegranate.

8 There's no one like her on earth, never has been, never will be.

- 8 Sixty queens there may be, and eighty concubines, and virgins beyond number;
- 9 She's a woman beyond compare. My dove is perfection, Pure and innocent as the day she was born, and cradled in joy by her mother. Everyone who came by to see her exclaimed and admired her-- All the fathers and mothers, the neighbors and friends, blessed and praised her:
- 9 but my dove, my perfect one, is unique, the only daughter of her mother, the favorite of the one who bore her. The maidens saw her and called her blessed; the queens and concubines praised her.
- 10 "Has anyone ever seen anything like this-- dawn-fresh, moon-lovely, sun-radiant, ravishing as the night sky with its galaxies of stars?"
- 10 Who is this that appears like the dawn, fair as the moon, bright as the sun, majestic as the stars in procession?
- 11 One day I went strolling through the orchard, looking for signs of spring, Looking for buds about to burst into flower, anticipating readiness, ripeness.
- 11 I went down to the grove of nut trees to look at the new growth in the valley, to see if the vines had budded or the pomegranates were in bloom.
- 12 Before I knew it my heart was raptured, carried away by lofty thoughts!
- 12 Before I realized it, my desire set me among the royal chariots of my people.
- 13 Dance, dance, dear Shulammite, Angel-Princess! Dance, and we'll feast our eyes on your grace! Everyone wants to see the Shulammite dance her victory dances of love and peace.
- 13 Come back, come back, O Shulammite; come back, come back, that we may gaze on you! Why would you gaze on the Shulammite as on the dance of Mahanaim?

Song of Solomon 7

MSG

NIV

- 1 Shapely and graceful your sandaled feet, and queenly your movement--
Your limbs are lithe and elegant, the work of a master artist.

- 1 How beautiful your sandaled feet, O prince's daughter! Your graceful legs are like jewels, the work of a craftsman's hands.
- 2 Your body is a chalice, wine-filled. Your skin is silken and tawny like a field of wheat touched by the breeze.
- 2 Your navel is a rounded goblet that never lacks blended wine. Your waist is a mound of wheat encircled by lilies.
- 3 Your breasts are like fawns, twins of a gazelle.
- 3 Your breasts are like two fawns, twins of a gazelle.
- 4 Your neck is carved ivory, curved and slender. Your eyes are wells of light, deep with mystery. Quintessentially feminine! Your profile turns all heads, commanding attention.
- 4 Your neck is like an ivory tower. Your eyes are the pools of Heshbon by the gate of Bath Rabbim. Your nose is like the tower of Lebanon looking toward Damascus.
- 5 The feelings I get when I see the high mountain ranges --stirrings of desire, longings for the heights-- Remind me of you, and I'm spoiled for anyone else!
- 5 Your head crowns you like Mount Carmel. Your hair is like royal tapestry; the king is held captive by its tresses.
- 6 Your beauty, within and without, is absolute, dear lover, close companion.
- 6 How beautiful you are and how pleasing, O love, with your delights!
- 7 You are tall and supple, like the palm tree, and your full breasts are like sweet clusters of dates.
- 7 Your stature is like that of the palm, and your breasts like clusters of fruit.
- 8 I say, "I'm going to climb that palm tree! I'm going to caress its fruit!" Oh yes! Your breasts will be clusters of sweet fruit to me, Your breath clean and cool like fresh mint,
- 8 I said, "I will climb the palm tree; I will take hold of its fruit." May your breasts be like the clusters of the vine, the fragrance of your breath like apples,
- 9 your tongue and lips like the best wine. Yes, and yours are, too--my love's kisses flow from his lips to mine.
- 9 and your mouth like the best wine. May the wine go straight to my lover, flowing gently over lips and teeth.
- 10 I am my lover's. I'm all he wants. I'm all the world to him!

- 10 I belong to my lover, and his desire is for me.
- 11 Come, dear lover-- let's tramp through the countryside.
- 11 Come, my lover, let us go to the countryside, let us spend the night in the villages.
- 12 Let's sleep at some wayside inn, then rise early and listen to bird-song. Let's look for wildflowers in bloom, blackberry bushes blossoming white, Fruit trees festooned with cascading flowers. And there I'll give myself to you, my love to your love!
- 12 Let us go early to the vineyards to see if the vines have budded, if their blossoms have opened, and if the pomegranates are in bloom-- there I will give you my love.
- 13 Love-apples drench us with fragrance, fertility surrounds, suffuses us, Fruits fresh and preserved that I've kept and saved just for you, my love.
- 13 The mandrakes send out their fragrance, and at our door is every delicacy, both new and old, that I have stored up for you, my lover.

Song of Solomon 8

MSG

NIV

- 1 I wish you'd been my twin brother, sharing with me the breasts of my mother, Playing outside in the street, kissing in plain view of everyone, and no one thinking anything of it.
- 1 If only you were to me like a brother, who was nursed at my mother's breasts! Then, if I found you outside, I would kiss you, and no one would despise me.
- 2 I'd take you by the hand and bring you home where I was raised by my mother. You'd drink my wine and kiss my cheeks.
- 2 I would lead you and bring you to my mother's house-- she who has taught me. I would give you spiced wine to drink, the nectar of my pomegranates.
- 3 Imagine! His left hand cradling my head, his right arm around my waist!
- 3 His left arm is under my head and his right arm embraces me.
- 4 Oh, let me warn you, sisters in Jerusalem: Don't excite love, don't stir it up, until the time is ripe--and you're ready.

- 4 Daughters of Jerusalem, I charge you: Do not arouse or awaken love until it so desires.
- 5 Who is this I see coming up from the country, arm in arm with her lover? I found you under the apricot tree, and woke you up to love. Your mother went into labor under that tree, and under that very tree she bore you.
- 5 Who is this coming up from the desert leaning on her lover? Under the apple tree I roused you; there your mother conceived you, there she who was in labor gave you birth.
- 6 Hang my locket around your neck, wear my ring on your finger. Love is invincible facing danger and death. Passion laughs at the terrors of hell. The fire of love stops at nothing-- it sweeps everything before it.
- 6 Place me like a seal over your heart, like a seal on your arm; for love is as strong as death, its jealousy unyielding as the grave. It burns like blazing fire, like a mighty flame.
- 7 Flood waters can't drown love, torrents of rain can't put it out. Love can't be bought, love can't be sold-- it's not to be found in the marketplace.
- 7 Many waters cannot quench love; rivers cannot wash it away. If one were to give all the wealth of his house for love, it would be utterly scorned.
- 8 My brothers used to worry about me: "Our little sister has no breasts. What shall we do with our little sister when men come asking for her?"
- 8 We have a young sister, and her breasts are not yet grown. What shall we do for our sister for the day she is spoken for?
- 9 She's a virgin and vulnerable, and we'll protect her. If they think she's a wall, we'll top it with barbed wire. If they think she's a door, we'll barricade it."
- 9 If she is a wall, we will build towers of silver on her. If she is a door, we will enclose her with panels of cedar.
- 10 Dear brothers, I'm a walled-in virgin still, but my breasts are full-- And when my lover sees me, he knows he'll soon be satisfied.
- 10 I am a wall, and my breasts are like towers. Thus I have become in his eyes like one bringing contentment.
- 11 King Solomon may have vast vineyards in lush, fertile country, Where he hires others to work the ground. People pay anything to get in on that bounty.
- 11 Solomon had a vineyard in Baal Hamon; he let out his vineyard to tenants. Each was to bring for its fruit a thousand shekels of silver.

- 12 But my vineyard is all mine, and I'm keeping it to myself. You can have your vast vineyards, Solomon, you and your greedy guests!
- 12 But my own vineyard is mine to give; the thousand shekels are for you, O Solomon, and two hundred are for those who tend its fruit.
- 13 Oh, lady of the gardens, my friends are with me listening. Let me hear your voice!
- 13 You who dwell in the gardens with friends in attendance, let me hear your voice!
- 14 Run to me, dear lover. Come like a gazelle. Leap like a wild stag on the spice mountains.
- 14 Come away, my lover, and be like a gazelle or like a young stag on the spice-laden mountains.